

Installing Microsoft Network Monitor on Windows: To test WiFi adapter

This guide provides detailed step-by-step instructions for students to download, install, and verify Microsoft Network Monitor 3.4 on a Windows system. All instructions are based on official Microsoft documentation and supporting technical sources.

The purpose is to test if your WiFi adapter can be placed into monitor mode.

STEP 1: Download Microsoft Network Monitor

1. Visit the official Microsoft download page: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/download/details.aspx?id=4865>

2. Click the Download button.

3. Select the correct installer based on your system:

- NM34_x86.exe for 32-bit systems

OR

- NM34_x64.exe for 64-bit systems

4. Click Next to begin the download.

STEP 2: Run the Installer

1. Locate the downloaded file and run setup.exe.

2. The installer will first install the core engine. Follow the prompts.

3. Ensure all instances of netmon.exe, nmcap.exe, or NMAPI-dependent programs are closed before proceeding.

STEP 3: Install the Parser Package

1. After the core engine installation, you will be prompted to install the Network Monitor Parser Package.

2. Follow the prompts to complete installation.

STEP 4: Restart the Computer

A system reboot is required so Network Monitor can detect all network adapters properly.

STEP 5: Launch Network Monitor

1. Click Start → search for "Network Monitor" or "netmon".

2. Right-click and select Run as Administrator.

STEP 6: Verify Adapters

1. When Network Monitor opens, confirm that all network adapters appear.

2. If Wi-Fi adapters do not appear, restart the computer again.

OPTIONAL: Testing Wi-Fi Adapter for Monitor Mode

1. Click New Capture.

2. Open Capture Settings and deselect all adapters except Wi-Fi.

3. Click Start.

- **If packet capture begins, the adapter supports monitor mode.**

- **If errors occur, the adapter likely does not support monitor mode.**